

Figure 5.6: Swiss cheese

their cellular enzymes on lactose, fat and proteins that creates the ripened cheese flavour. The gas forming culture of *Propionibacterium shermanii* is essential for giving swiss cheese its eye, or holes and flavour (Figure 5.6).

The specificity of cheese depends upon the varieties of microorganisms used. The process of cheese making, involves nine steps:

a. Preparing the milk
b. Forming a curd.
c. Cutting
d. Cooking
e. Separating the whey
f. Salting the residue
g. Applying microbes
h. Pressing the curd
i. Ripening the young cheese

Types of Cheese

Cheese can be divided among different categories or types, according to their firmness. There are various system for classifying cheese and there are variations within each system (Table 5.6).

5.7 Yoghurt or Bulgarian Milk

Yoghurt is derived from a Turkish word 'Jugurt' which is the most popular fermented milk in the world now – a – days. It is made

Table 5.6: Types of Cheese

Soft cheese	
	Soft, Smooth and creamy texture. Soft cheese is not pressed or cooked during the manufacturing process. Example: Camembert
Semi-soft cheese	
	A little more firm and compact than soft cheese, the semi-soft category contains the largest variety of cheese. Example: Havarti
Firm cheese	
	Cheese in the category is considered to be an "all purpose" cheese. Cheese is pressed to remove as much whey as possible after the curdling process which creates a firm cheese. Example: Cheddar

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